

JOHN PATTERSON

Patterson's 49 Nearly Breaks the Record

A man with only one previous TEG round to his name carded the second-highest points total in the competition's history, recovering from an early wobble to do it.

John Patterson's second round at Praia D'El Rey came to 49 points. It is the second-best round total in TEG history to date. It did not arrive gracefully.

He began with three straight bogeys, holes 1 to 3, the golfing equivalent of clearing one's throat for a very long time. Then it got worse. Holes 4 to 6 cost him eight shots: a double bogey, then two triple bogeys, one of them at the 5th, which is among the hardest holes on the course. Six holes in, he was a man with nothing but arithmetic for

company. He birdied the 7th. The bleeding stopped there.

What followed was an avalanche. Patterson gathered 17 points across holes 9 to 13, including a birdie at the 12th. He then took 14 more from the final four holes. Having posted 38 in Round 1, his 49 here represented an 11-shot swing. It carried him into the lead of the TEG 2 Trophy race, past Jon Baker, and opened a gap of ten points. He had begun the day dropping shots in threes. He ended it in front of everybody.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY John PATTERSON (49 pts)
TROPHY LEAD John PATTERSON, 10 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD David MULLIN, 7 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD
JP 49 AB 44 DM 39 JB 37 GW 36 SN 30
ROUND GROSS
DM +14 JP +14 JB +19 AB +27 GW +28 SN +32

AFTER R2 • TROPHY
JP 87 DM 77 AB 76 JB 76 GW 67 SN 53
AFTER R2 • GREEN JACKET
DM +29 JB +36 JP +42 GW +63 AB +70 SN +74

JON BAKER

Baker's Slender Lead Disappears

Jon Baker's one-point cushion atop the TEG 9 Trophy is gone, undone less by anything Patterson did to him directly than by a ragged middle nine of his own.

Jon Baker began the second round at Praia D'El Rey a single point clear in the TEG 16 Trophy race. The lead lasted until the middle of his card, and not a hole longer. From the 5th he went three holes without a net par. A double bogey at the 5th. Another at the 6th. A triple bogey at the par-5 7th. Seven shots gone, in the calm manner of a man conceding territory he had never really controlled.

He did recover, briefly. Three straight pars from the 11th suggested order restored. Then came the quadruple bogey at the short 14th, the same stroke-index-17 hole that had already had Alex Baker, and the run was over.

While Baker came apart, John Patterson took the outright Trophy lead with a bogey at the 1st and held it to the close. A bogey was all it required,

which says something about the standard of the opposition. Baker's one-point advantage overnight became a ten-point deficit by the finish. Elsewhere David Mullin quietly retained his Green Jacket lead, extending it from two points to seven across the same round. Nobody appeared to notice him doing it.

PRAIA D'EL REY

Praia D'El Rey Draws Blood

The par-4 9th and the short 14th combined to wreck four separate scorecards, a reminder of why this course is treated with such respect.

Two holes did most of the damage in Round 2. Four players left their cards in ruins between the 5th and the 14th.

Gregg Williams took a sextuple bogey 10 at the par-4 9th. Stroke index 4, and no respecter of ambition. It also collected Stuart Neumann for a quadruple bogey 8. Neumann had already posted a quadruple bogey 8 at the 5th, stroke index 2 and one of the hardest holes on the course. From there his round simply stopped resisting. He finished 21 strokes worse than his previous visit here, which takes a certain commitment. He remains anchored to the bottom of the 2016 TEG Wooden Spoon race, and the gap behind him widened from 8 shots to 14. He is not so much losing this race as sponsoring it.

The short par-3 14th did the rest. Stroke index 17, normally one of the kinder holes on the property, a hole most men walk past without remembering. Alex Baker and Jon Baker each took a quadruple bogey 7 there. For Jon Baker it was expensive. He had led the Trophy race overnight. He ended the round 10 shots behind the new leader, John Patterson.

ALEX BAKER

Alex Baker's Total Turnaround

A day after carding the worst gross round of his TEG career, Alex Baker returned to Praia D'El Rey and beat his own course record by nine shots.

A day after carding the worst gross round of his life, Alex Baker arrived at Praia D'El Rey and rewrote his own records. Round 1 had yielded 32 points. Round 2 gave him 44, a personal-best round, underpinned by a gross score of +27, also a personal best.

This was not a tidy performance. Baker shed 8 shots across holes 10 to 12. The centrepiece was a quadruple bogey 9 at the par-5 10th, one of the easier stroke-index holes out there, which he treated with the gravity it did not deserve. A double bogey at the short 11th followed. Then another at the par-5 12th, for completeness.

The rest of the card was good enough to absorb all of it. It stands as his best gross score in three visits to Praia D'El Rey, nine shots better than anything he had managed here before, and comfortably his best figures for the course this TEG. Progress, arriving by the scenic route.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 9, Round 2

TEG RECORDS

- John Patterson's 49 pts is the 2nd-best round in TEG history to date
- John Patterson — 30 Stableford on the Back nine is the best Back nine Stableford in TEG history

PERSONAL BESTS

- Alex Baker posts a personal-best round: 44 pts
- Alex Baker posts a personal-best Gross round: +27